Windows & Wet-Weather Cheat Sheet

Streak-free glass on a low budget, plus jobs for rainy days.

Cheap streak-free window mix

2 cups warm water + 1/4 cup white vinegar + a drop of dish soap. Spray bottle, old cotton T-shirt or microfiber cloth, and a dry towel for edges. Skip vinegar on stone sills; skip paper towels if you hate lint streaks.

The window method (cloudy days are your friend)

1. **Cloudy or shaded, not sunny** — direct sun dries the mix before you can wipe, and that's what creates streaks.
2. **Dry-dust sills, tracks, and frames first.** Wet dust turns to paste.
3. **Wet pass top to bottom**, then a single squeegee or cloth pass also top to bottom, overlapping strokes.
4. **Edge-dry with the towel's short side** pressed into each window's bottom corner — this is where streaks hide.
5. **Inside the sash screens:** pop them out, hose them, dry them in the sun flat (not leaning — leaning bows them).

Wet-weather job list (when it pours, win inside)

- [ ] Entry mats shaken & dried — the mud patrol HQ
- [ ] Coat corner declutter + boot tray wipe
- [ ] Humidity check: run the bath fan, wipe windowsill moisture
  Condensation seasons are mold seasons.
- [ ] Indoor sills: wipe tracks, check weep holes run free
- [ ] Dehumidifier emptied & filter rinsed
- [ ] Basement / closet musty-check corners
- [ ] Lamp dust + bulb wipe (lights read dimmer when dusty)
- [ ] Plant leaves wipe & check for winter pests
- [ ] Bookshelf quick tidy & cozy-day pile decided
- [ ] Backup battery / flashlight check before storms

Rain-day short list (dream job: 15 min)

1 shake of the mats, 1 wiped sill, 1 damp-room fan jurisdiction, 1 musty-corner sniff, 1 drawer finished. Pour yourself something warm — done is done.

The outside-jobs hail mary

Write your outside gunk list — gutters, mildewed siding, deck grime — on this page and stop guilt-y. Wet days are for the inside list; the outside days greet the sun.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Common window questions

IDEA	STRAIGHT ANSWER
Newspaper on glass	Works (no streak lint), but ink and modern soy-ink vary — a microfiber cloth is safer for frames.
Streaks on every wipe	Too much soap. One drop, not a squirt. And dry-dust first: most “streaks” are wet dust.
Fog between double-pane panes	Seal failure — cleaning won't fix it; it goes on the Big-Ticket wish list or a glazier call.
Paint flecks on glass	Razor scraper at a shallow angle, wet. Skip on tempered glass with a coating (check window label).
Stuck windows in spring	Run a putty knife around the sash, tap gently, then open slowly. Never lever the frame.
Cleaning window screens	Soft brush + that same vinegar mix, rinse, air-dry flat.
Best pace for a whole house	Two or three windows per day beats one heroic Saturday morning. Seriously.

Safe rain rule

Wet decks, ladders, and roofs do not mix. If a job needs a ladder or the great outdoors, it waits for dry weather — that's a job-list move, not a courage move.

Clean glass springs a house forward faster than almost anything else. Two windows a day for a week and every room suddenly has more light.